CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

VIT Bhopal University | VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

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Year	First Year (2025–2029)
University	VIT Bhopal University
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
Date	March 2026

Introduction

This report documents my work for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project scenario placed me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — someone responsible for helping fellow students navigate the digital world safely, responsibly, and professionally.

To fulfil this role, I completed five tasks, each mapping to one module of the course. These tasks covered creating a digital literacy awareness infographic, building a professional online presence across multiple platforms, exploring coding and collaboration tools, learning the rules of professional email communication, and researching cybercrime awareness. All my work has been organized into a single GitHub repository which forms part of the final submission.

I found this project more useful than I expected. It pushed me to actually set up accounts I had been putting off, write real professional emails, and think carefully about how I present myself online. Everything I built here will continue to be part of my digital portfolio throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I used **Canva** (canva.com) to design a one-page digital literacy infographic meant to help my batchmates understand the core ideas behind being digitally literate. I chose Canva because it is completely free, browser-based, and gives a lot of flexibility when it comes to layout and color without needing any design experience.

The infographic is divided into five sections, each with its own colour scheme so it is easy to read at a glance. The first section defines what digital literacy actually means. The second lists useful digital tools for students such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Drive, and HackerRank. The third section covers safe internet practices and includes the National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930 and the portal cybercrime.gov.in. The fourth section explains how to maintain a professional online presence, and the fifth is an annotated email etiquette mockup. At the very bottom, there is a social media Do's and Don'ts panel.

One thing I found particularly interesting while making this was figuring out how much information to fit into a single page without making it look cluttered. I had a lot more I wanted to include, but I kept trimming content down and finding shorter ways to say the same thing. It made me realize how much thought goes into effective visual communication.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I set up professional profiles on three platforms: **GitHub, LinkedIn,** and **Kaggle.** I chose these three because they are the most directly relevant to someone studying Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, and they are also the platforms that recruiters and internship coordinators are most likely to check.

GitHub

GitHub is a platform for hosting and sharing code. I created a special profile README repository — a unique GitHub feature where a repository named exactly after your username appears as a bio on your profile page. My README displays my name, branch, registration number, university, year, and a short sentence about what I hope to learn. I plan to use GitHub to upload coding assignments and personal projects as I grow more confident with programming.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform used by working professionals, recruiters, and companies worldwide. I filled in my Education section with my current degree (B.Tech – Computer Science), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year (June 2029). Over the next four years, I plan to keep updating my profile as I complete certifications, projects, and internships.

Kaggle

Kaggle is a platform designed specifically for data science and machine learning. It hosts competitions, datasets, notebooks, and free learning courses. I set up my profile as an AI/ML Engineering Student at VIT Bhopal University. I plan to work through their beginner courses and take part in entry-level competitions once my programming foundations are stronger.

Setting up all three profiles in one sitting was genuinely satisfying. It made me feel like I was taking my future career seriously right from the first year, rather than waiting until the final year like many students tend to do.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This task had two parts. For Part A, I created an account on **HackerRank** and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. HackerRank is a platform where students and professionals can practice programming problems across different languages and difficulty levels. Many companies also use HackerRank to conduct coding assessments during their hiring process, so getting familiar with it early feels like a smart move.

For Part B, I created a **Google Form** titled 'Digital Literacy Quiz' with five questions — four multiple choice and one short answer. The questions covered topics like the definition of digital literacy, safe internet habits, what GitHub is used for, the cybercrime helpline number 1930, and how to identify a phishing attempt. The form was linked to a Google Sheet that automatically collects responses, which is a very practical feature for conducting surveys and quizzes.

I found the Google Forms experience genuinely useful. It was the first time I properly explored how Forms and Sheets work together, and I can already see how I might use this combination for group project feedback or event registrations in the future.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

For this task, I wrote two professional emails and created a social media Do's and Don'ts checklist. The first email was from a student to a professor requesting a two-day extension on an assignment deadline. The second was from a student to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.

Both emails follow proper professional email conventions — they have a clear and specific subject line, a formal greeting using the recipient's title, a well-structured body that gets to the point without being unnecessarily long, and a formal sign-off including the student's full name and registration number. Writing these emails taught me that a short, well-written email is far more effective than a long one that rambles.

For the communication scenario, a situation I have personally witnessed comes to mind. A student once posted a complaint about a professor publicly on an Instagram story, naming the professor directly. Within a day, the post had been screenshotted and forwarded to the college administration. The student faced disciplinary action and had to apologise formally. The entire situation could have been avoided by simply sending a polite, private email expressing the concern. This showed me that the way we communicate digitally carries very real consequences, and pausing to think before posting or sending anything is a habit worth building from the very first year.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

For this task, I chose to research and write about **UPI Payment Fraud** — one of the most common cybercrimes targeting college students in India today. I wrote a 240-word case study based on a realistic fictional scenario involving a student who gets scammed while trying to sell a laptop on OLX. The case study explains what the crime is, walks through how it happens step by step, identifies who is usually targeted, and describes the consequences for the victim.

I also created a 'Stay Safe Online' checklist with ten actionable prevention tips, two of which are specifically about UPI and financial safety. The checklist also includes the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and the helpline number 1930.

The thing that surprised me most while researching this topic was the specific trick where scammers send a QR code and ask the victim to scan it in order to 'receive' money. I had always assumed that scanning a QR code was a passive action. I did not realize that if you enter your UPI PIN after scanning a collect request, you are authorizing a payment out of your own account, not into it. This deception works specifically because most people do not fully understand how UPI actually functions under the surface.

As a direct result of this research, the one habit I am personally going to change is that I will never enter my UPI PIN unless I myself have initiated a payment. I will also pause and carefully verify any payment request before accepting it, regardless of how trustworthy the sender appears to be.

References

Working through this project from start to finish was more valuable than I expected a one-credit course to be. I came in thinking it would be a formality, but I ended up setting up profiles I had been avoiding, learning how UPI scams work in detail, and thinking much more carefully about how I communicate and present myself online. The GitHub repository I built for this submission is now a real part of my digital identity — something I intend to keep adding to throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal University.

References

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